

DF-61

The **Dongfeng-61** (simplified Chinese: 东风-61; traditional Chinese: 東風-61; lit. 'East Wind-61', **DF-61**) is an intercontinental ballistic missile developed by the People's Republic of China. It is likely nuclear-armed and may be a variant or successor to the DF-41.

Description

The DF-61 is a road-mobile missile and is likely nuclear-armed.^{[1][2]} The transporter erector launcher is seemingly identical to the one used by the DF-41; the DF-61 may be a variant^[1] or successor to the DF-41.^[2] Reported ranges include 7,500 miles (12,100 km) - similar to the DF-41^[3]- and 18,000 kilometres (11,000 mi)^[2]

History

The missile made its first official public appearance during the 2025 China Victory Day Parade as part of the nuclear missile section. A Federation of American Scientists article described the appearance of the DF-61 as a "surprise" since it seemed similar to the DF-41, a missile already deployed at the time.^[1]

Earlier "DF-61" program

The "DF-61" designation was used by a tactical nuclear missile development program from 1976-1977.^[4] It was a response to North Korea's interest to acquire 600 km range missiles from China, although no agreement was made.^[5] Development began as a counter to the Soviet Union. The decision not to emphasize tactical weapons in the nuclear weapons program probably ended development.^[6]

References

1.
- Kristensen, Hans M.; Eliana Johns; Matt Korda; Mackenzie Knight-Boyle (4 September 2025). "Nuclear Weapons At China's 2025 Victory Day Parade" (<https://fas.org/publication/nuclear-weapons-at-chinas-2025-victory-day-parade/>). *Federation of American Scientists*. Retrieved 4 September 2025.

DF-61



DF-61 missile at the 2025 Victory Day Parade

Type	Intercontinental ballistic missile
Place of origin	China
Service history	
In service	2025–present
Used by	People's Liberation Army Rocket Force
Specifications	
Operational range	~12,100–18,000 kilometres (7,500–11,200 mi)
Launch platform	Transporter erector launcher

2. "Chinese military parade highlights rapid progress towards modernisation" (<https://www.janes.com/defence-intelligence-insights/defence-and-national-security-analysis/chinese-military-parade-highlights-rapid-modernisation>). *Janes*. 2 September 2025. Retrieved 11 June 2026.
3. Sabbagh, Dan (3 September 2025). "Nuclear triad and 'robot wolves': parade shows off array of Chinese weapons" (<https://www.theguardian.com/world/2025/sep/03/nuclear-triad-r-obot-wolves-china-weapons-parade>). *The Guardian*. Retrieved 4 September 2025.
4. Zhang 2025, p. 122.
5. Zhang 2025, pp. 122–123.
6. Zhang 2025, p. 123.

Sources

- Zhang, Hui (2025). *The Untold Story of China's Nuclear Weapon Development and Testing: A Technical History*. Belfer Center Studies in International Security. Cambridge, Massachusetts: [The MIT Press](#). ISBN [978-0-262-05182-8](#).

See also

- [China and weapons of mass destruction](#)
-

Retrieved from "<https://en.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=DF-61&oldid=1358925145>"